

C-command effects in binding third-person reflexives and pronoun in Turkish

Özge Bakay & Brian Dillon
University of Massachusetts Amherst
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Question of the study

? Does *c-command* affect the antecedent choices of Turkish 3rd-person pronoun and reflexives?

- On-line sensitivity to **c-command** in resolving binding dependencies

(e.g., Dillon et al., 2013; Kush et al., 2015; Moulton & Han, 2015)

BUT investigation of **Turkish** reflexives so far → mostly on locality!

(Gračanin-Yüksek et al., 2017; Özbek & Kahraman, 2016; Özturhan, 2018; Sezer, 2020)

- In Turkish pronouns and anaphors are **pre-verbal**

a better testing ground to test the role of syntactic cues due to lack of verbal adjacency

(e.g., Kush & Phillips, 2014)

Overview of the results

? Does *c-command* affect the antecedent choices of Turkish 3rd-person pronoun and reflexives?

Finding I: 3rd-person pronoun is constrained by **Principle B**

Finding II: Both bare and the inflected reflexive: **local** > non-local antecedents

Finding III: Bare reflexive is more sensitive to **c-command** than the inflected reflexive

Online studies to come!!!

Background

- Third-person singular pronoun **o** → no local antecedents

NP₁_i **NP**₂_j ... **o**_{i/*j/k} VERB

- Two forms of reflexives for 3rd-person

kendi → bare reflexive

pro **kendi-si** → inflected with the 3rd-person possessive marker -s/ (Kornfilt, 2000)

- Bare reflexive reflexive **kendi** → local or non-local (logophoric) antecedent

NP₁_i **NP**₂_j ... **kendi**_{i/j/*k} VERB (Legate et al., 2020; 2013; cf. Kornfilt, 2000)

- Inflected reflexive **kendisi** → local, non-local or sentence-external antecedents

NP₁_i **NP**₂_j ... **kendisi**_{i/j/k} VERB (Enç, 1989; Gürel, 2002, 2004; Kornfilt, 2000)

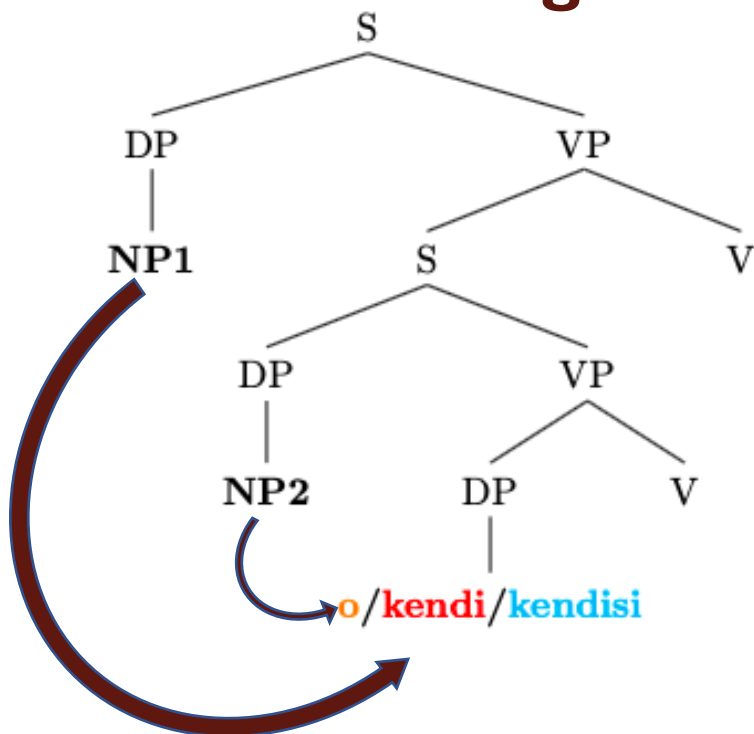
Stimuli

morpho-syntactic cues

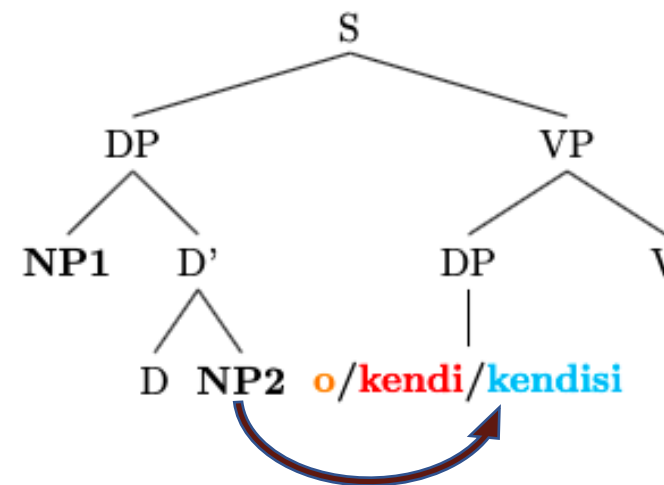
NP1 NP2 ... o/kendi/kendisi VERB

Ask in
Q&A!

C-commanding NP1
C-commanding NP2



Non-c-commanding NP1
C-commanding NP2



NP1 both structurally and linearly *non-local*
NP2 both structurally and linearly *local*

Antecedent Choice Task

NPI NP2 pronoun

Doktorun hemşiresi bugünkü toplantıda ona kızdı.

Kızılan kişi kim? ← question

Mümkün olan tüm seçenekleri işaretleyin.

☒ Doktor

☒ Hemşire

☐ Bir başkası

← NPI
NP2
'other/someone else'

Devam

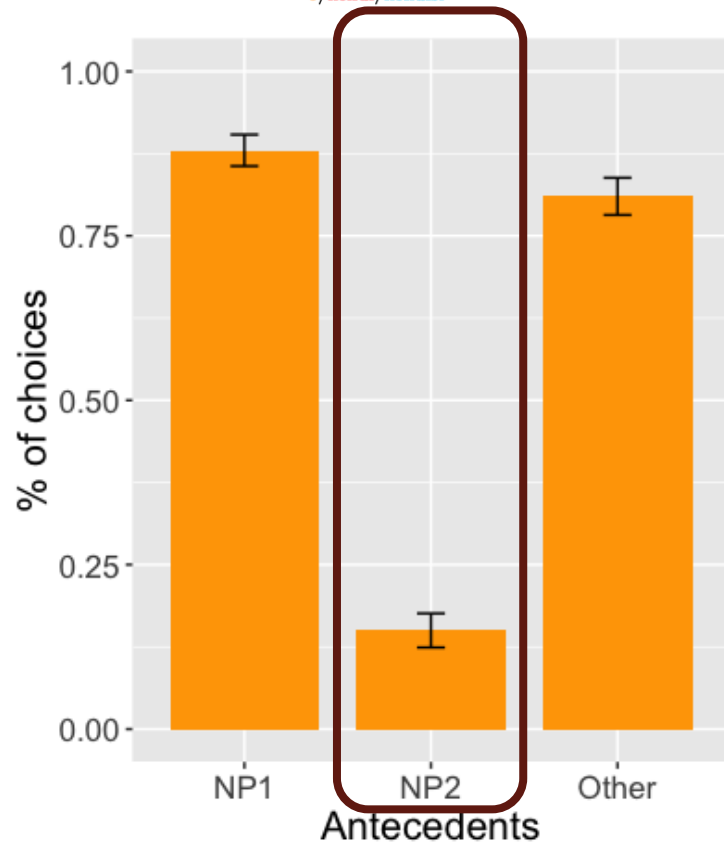
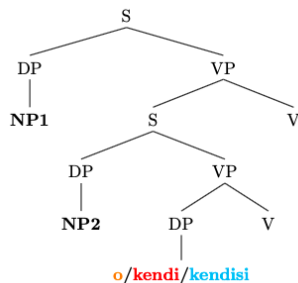
$N_{subject} = 32$

$N_{item} = 36$

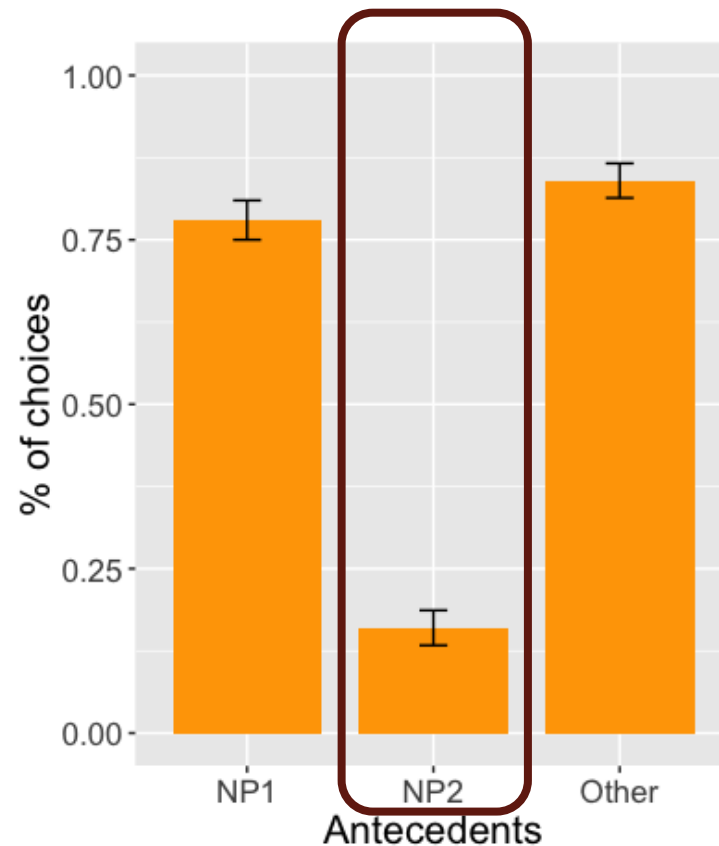
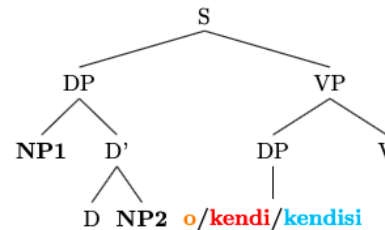


Results (“o”)

C-commanding NPI



Non-c-commanding NPI



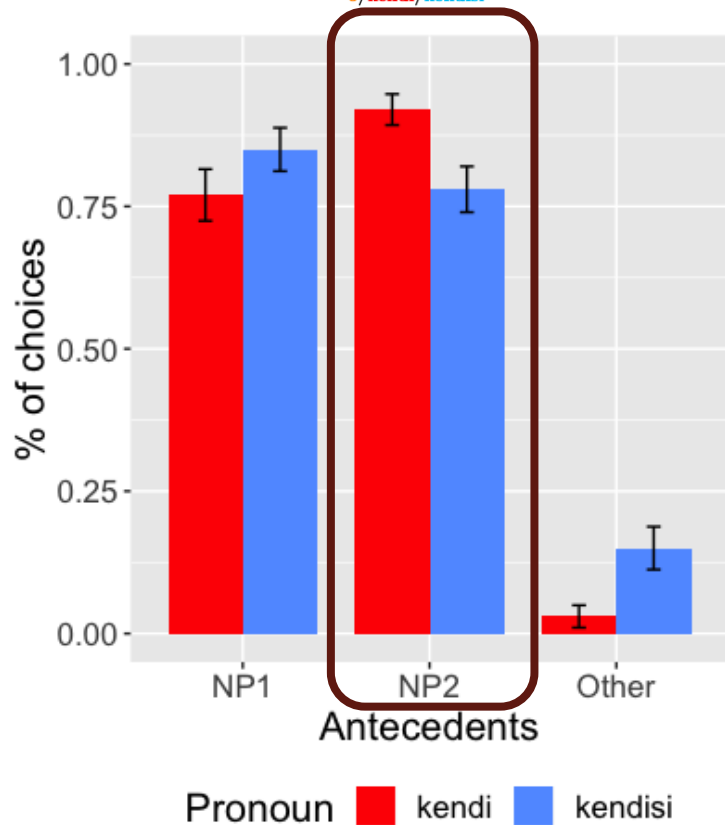
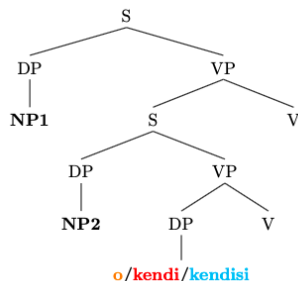
Finding 1:
Anti-locality preference

NP2 < NPI/‘other’

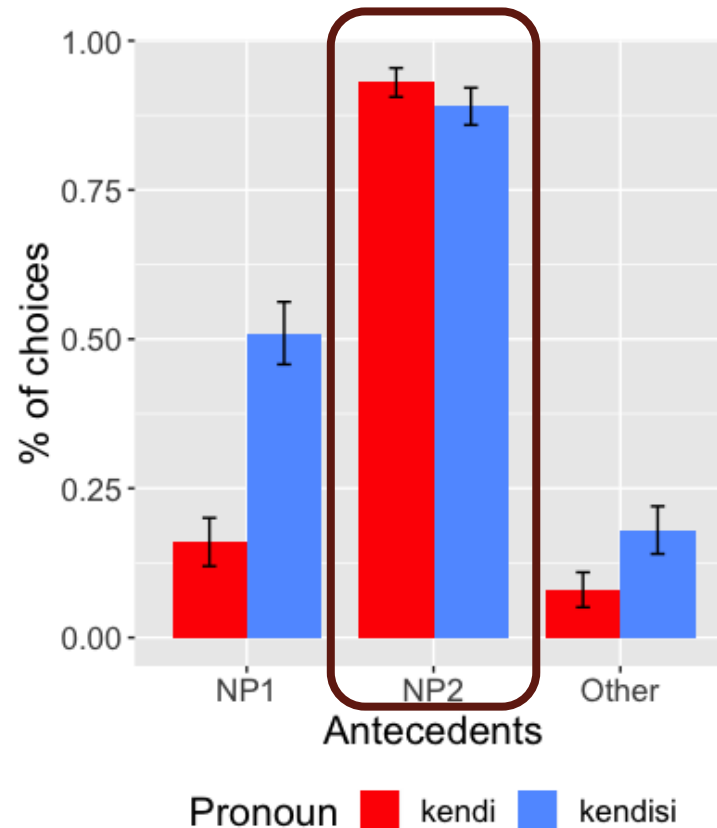
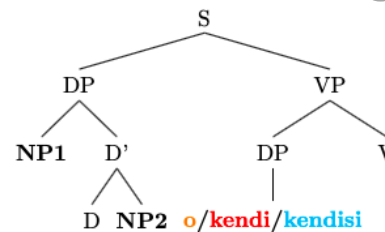
→ **Principle B**

Results (“kendi” vs. “kendisi”)

C-commanding NPI



Non-c-commanding NPI

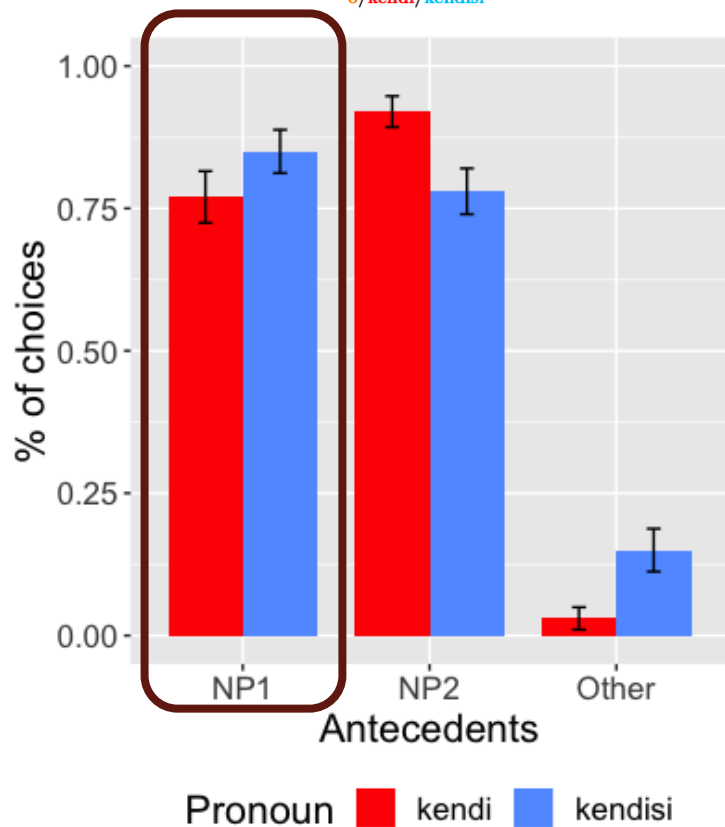
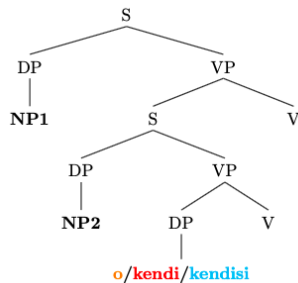


Finding II:
Locality preference

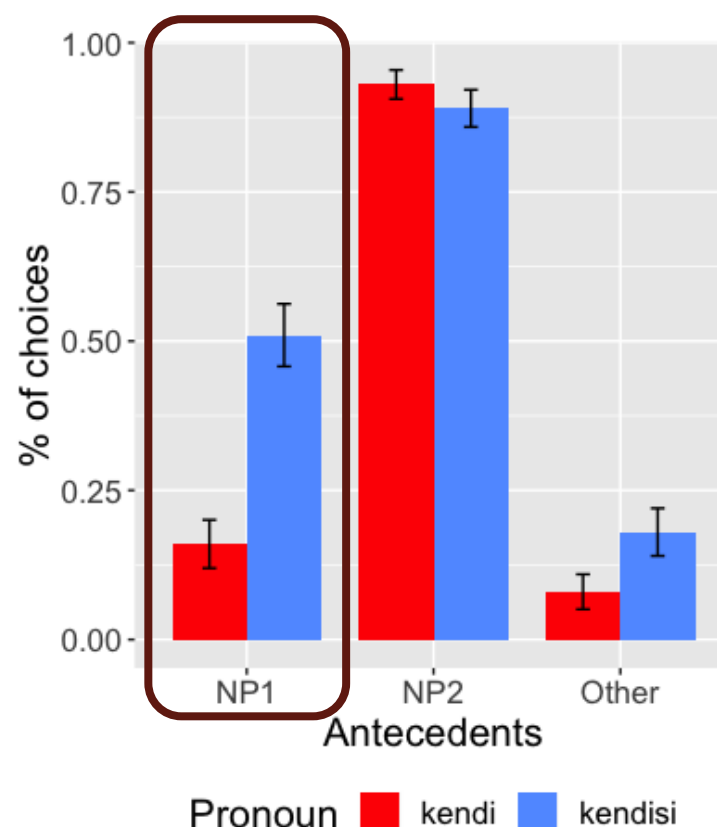
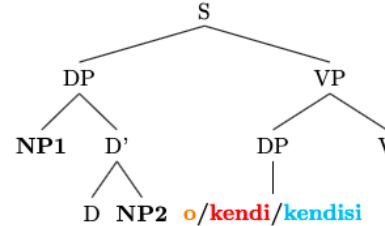
NP2 > NP1

Results (“kendi” vs. “kendisi”)

C-commanding NPI



Non-c-commanding NPI



Finding II:
Locality preference

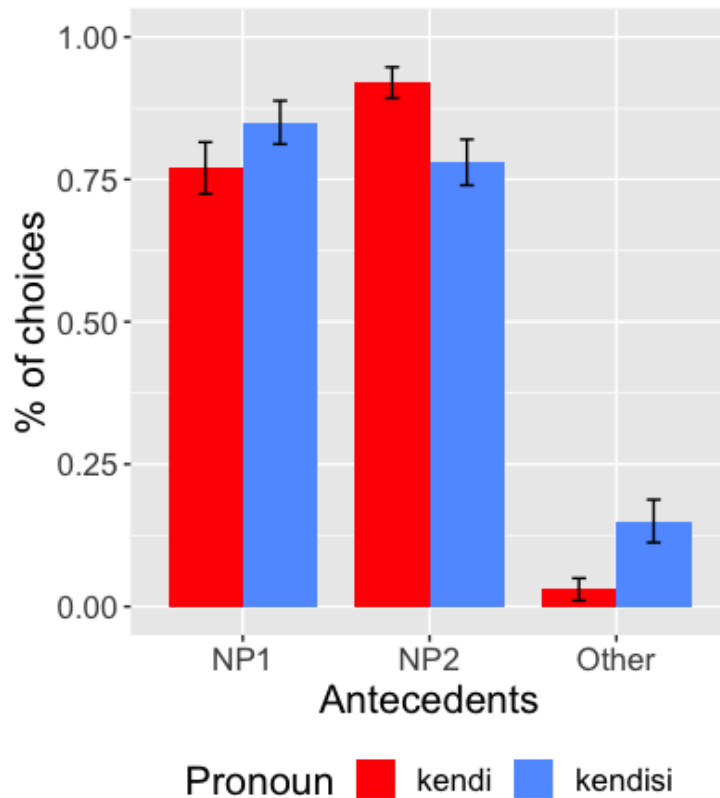
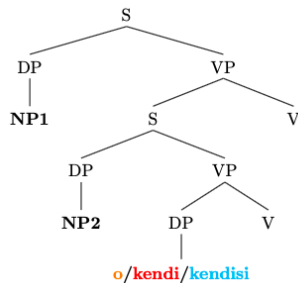
NP2 > NP1

Finding III:
C-command effects

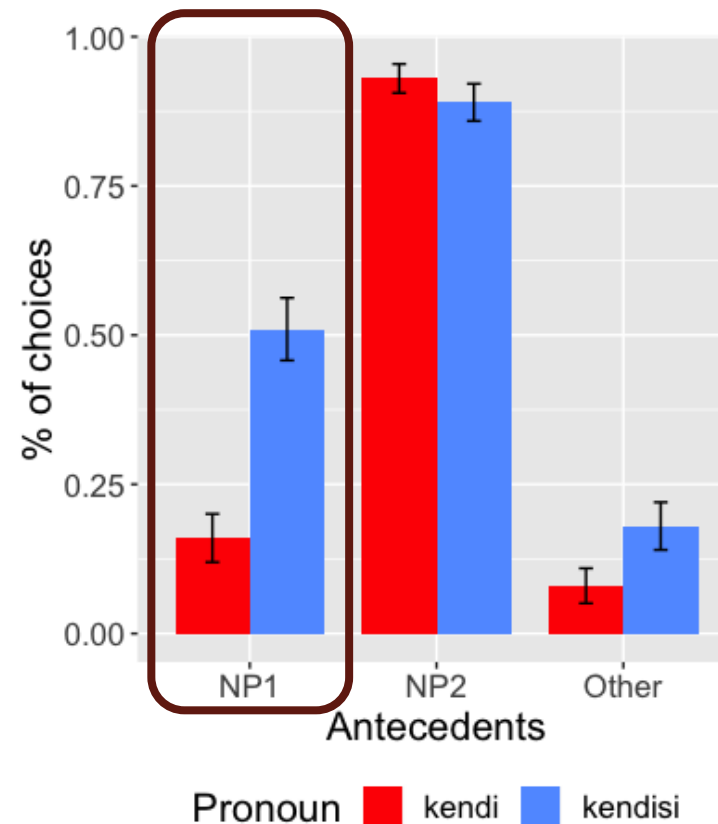
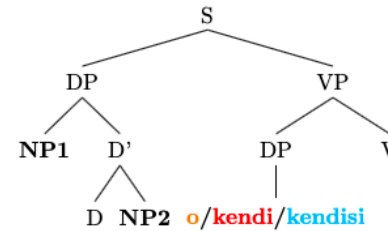
CC NPI > NoCC NPI

Results (“kendi” vs. “kendisi”)

C-commanding NPI



Non-c-commanding NPI



Finding II:
Locality preference

NP2 > NP1

Finding III:
C-command effects

CC NPI > NoCC NPI

kendi > kendisi

Findings

Finding I: *o* is constrained by Principle B

Finding II: for both bare reflexive *kendi* and 3rd-person-marked reflexive *kendisi*, local & long-distance binding are possible

- preference for local binding

Finding III: *kendi* and *kendisi* are both sensitive to c-command in long-distance binding, but not uniformly

- *kendisi* is less sensitive to c-command than *kendi*

(see Dillon et al., 2016 for similar results in Mandarin)

→ could be because of *pro* in the specifier of *kendisi*

References

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THANK YOU!

EXTRA

Materials

a. C-C(ommand)

Müdür-Ø sekreter-in ... o-nu/**kendi**-ni/**kendi-si**-ni öv-düğ-ün-ü bil-iyor-Ø
principal-NOM *secretary-GEN* ... them-/self-/self-POSS-ACC praise-FN-3SG-ACC know-PROG-3SG

‘The principal knows that the secretary is praising **them**/**themselves**/**themselves** all the time.’

b. NoC-C(ommand)

Müdür-ün sekreter-i ... o-nu/**kendi**-ni/**kendi-si**-ni öv-üyor-Ø
principal-GEN *secretary-POSS* ... them-/self-/self-POSS-ACC praise-PROG-3SG

‘The principal’s secretary is praising **them**/**themselves**/**themselves** all the time.’

Results (additional)

The percentages (%) for the choice of local, non-local and sentence-external ('other')

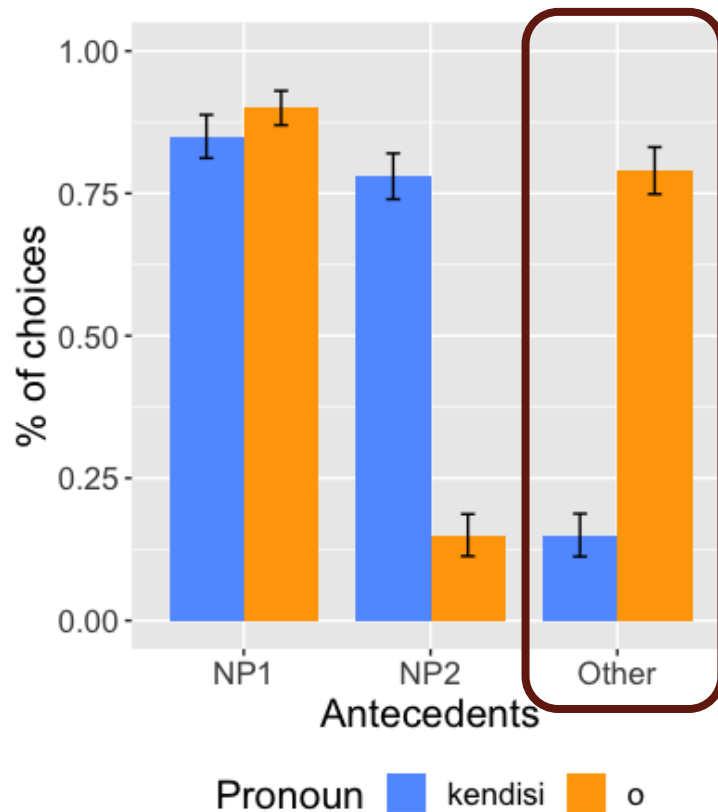
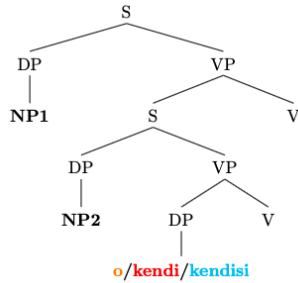
	<i>o</i>		<i>kendi</i>		<i>kendisi</i>	
	C-C	NoC-C	C-C	NoC-C	C-C	NoC-C
Local	15.10	16.15	90.10	93.75	79.17	91.15
Non-local	87.50	78.13	72.40	19.27	83.33	52.60
Other	81.25	84.38	5.21	10.42	14.58	20.31

Data Analysis

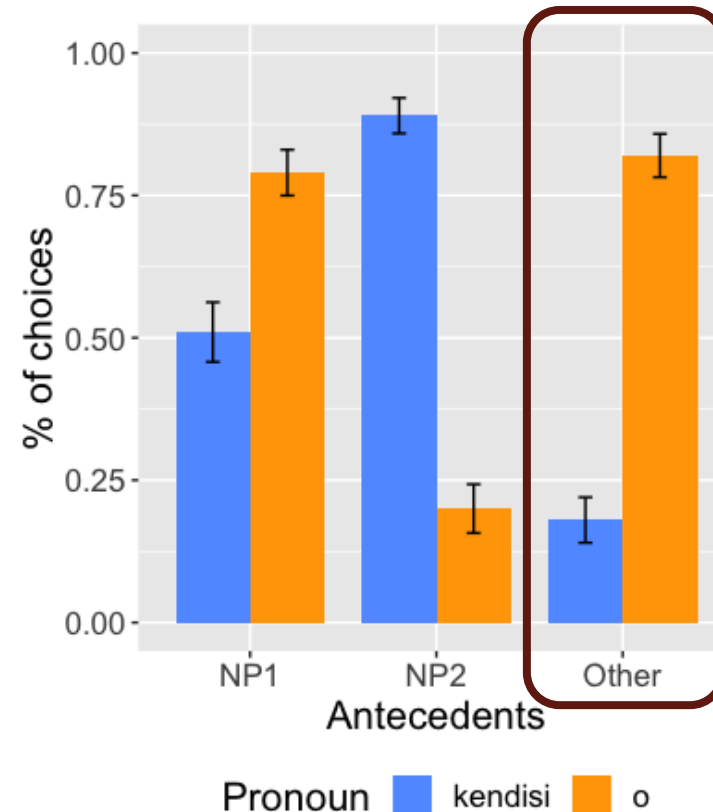
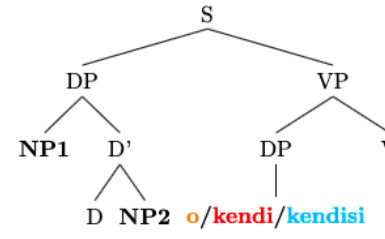
- the choice of antecedent(s) for each pronoun
- the effect of c-commanding on antecedent choice

Results (additional)

C-commanding NPI



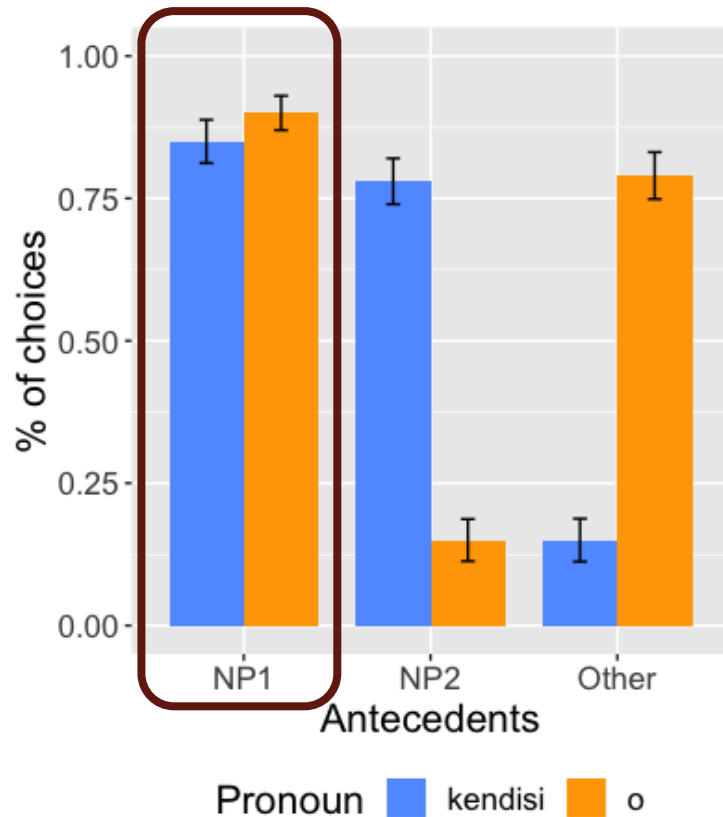
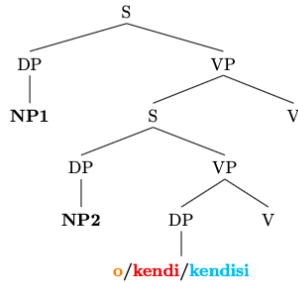
Non-c-commanding NPI



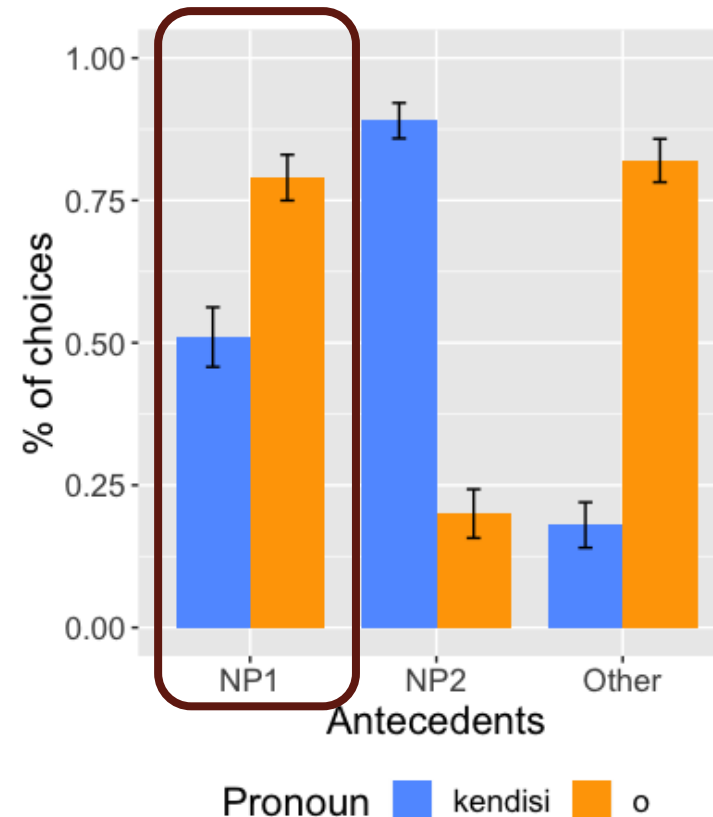
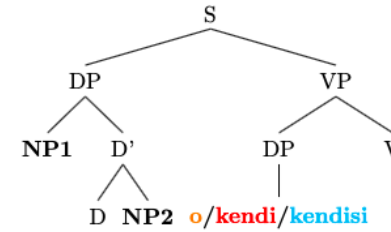
“Other”
o > kendisi

Results (additional)

C-commanding NPI



Non-c-commanding NPI



C-command

o → CC = NoCC

kendisi → CC > NoCC